

1. Llm-gemini 0.34

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-02T16:39:38+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/2/llm-gemini/>

Release: Llm-gemini 0.34 New model gemini-3.8-flash for Gemini 3.8 Flash , with low, medium and high thinking levels. #146 Fixed async responses failing to record the resolved model version. Thanks, Charlie Tonneslan . #137 Google released Gemini 3.8 Flash (and 3.8 Flash Cyber, but that's available to "trusted defenders" only) today. Here are the pelicans for high, medium, and low. This is high: For comparison, here are the same pelicans generated using Gemini 3.7 Flash . Something I appreciate about Gemini Flash is that it's fast, cheap, and competent at things like HTML and JavaScript. I was messing around with it and prompted "make me a cool thing in html" and it built this , which is certainly a cool thing in HTML! Took 13 seconds, cost 1.8 cents. Your browser does not support HTML5 video. If you click through to the demo you'll see one more thing I built with Gemini 3.8 Flash. My markdown-svg-renderer tool lets me feed in the URL to a Gist with Markdown in and renders that markdown with fenced code blocks for SVG correctly rendered. I used Gemini 3.8 Flash (with my very basic Llm-coding-agent coding agent plugin) to add support for HTML as well, so now any HTML blocks in the...

2. Claude's new system prompt really doesn't want to reproduce song lyrics

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-02T14:16:42+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/2/claudes-new-system-prompt/>

Anthropic publish the system prompts for their Claude consumer applications (Claude.ai and the Claude mobile apps - sadly not for Claude Cowork or Claude Code). I love that they do this, and that they share not just the current prompts but historic changes to their prompts as well. They used to keep all of the prompts on a single page, but when I checked today I noticed they had re-arranged those prompts into an index page and then a page per model - here's the page for Haiku 4.5 for example, which has the original prompt from October 15th 2025 and an updated prompt from January 18th 2026. A neat thing about Anthropic's platform.claude.com/docs site is that it's designed to be usable by LLMs. You can add .md to any page to get back the content as Markdown - here's the system prompt index page and the Markdown prompts for Fable 5.1 . TL;DR: this makes it really easy to diff the prompts. Don't reproduce song lyrics Don't draw copyrighted characters or logos Tweaks to Claude's answering style The missing end_conversation guidelines Recommended substance support sites Reliable cutoff date of June 2026 How I'm tracking these prompts Don't reproduce song lyrics Let's start with the mos...

3. Quoting Rick Brewster

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-02T05:50:57+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/2/rick-brewster/>

Direct2D has always been the biggest hurdle for Paint.NET on WINE, and it's clear that it will never be completed enough for Paint.NET's use. And I can't just "disable" the use of Direct2D. So, instead, Paint.NET now has an internal, from-scratch, clean-room reverse-engineered rewrite of Direct2D that it uses on WINE (triggered by using /wine). It lives in PaintDotNet.Windows.Direct2D1.Managed.dll . This was written by our good friend Claude , without whom this would NOT have been possible and would NEVER have happened. [...] Most of this code is, as they say, "vibe coded." By that I mean that it has not been thoroughly reviewed, it's more "trust me bro" style. I cannot possibly review 180,000 lines of code, it's just way way way too much. For reference, the rest of Paint.NET is about 700,000 lines of code and I've been working on it for over 20 years. [...] At times, Claude was working with the fury of 10 freshly unshackled Einstein genius-level 10x coders. And other times ... well, not so much. I had to babysit Claude quite a bit to make sure it did resource management correctly (for awhile it just wasn't doing the COM equivalent of AddRef() for reference counted objects, oops)...

4. iOS 27 Introduces New ?iPhone Handoff? Feature

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-02T20:58:28Z

Link: <https://www.macrumors.com/2026/09/02/ios-27-iphone-handoff-feature/>

Joe Rossignol, MacRumors: ?iPhone Handoff? can be set up from the Settings app, under the Cellular menu. During the setup process, you can choose which iPhone you want to be the main device that you use most often and which one you want to be the companion device. Apple says a user?s main eSIM will remain on the main iPhone, while the companion iPhone will receive a companion eSIM, and this will enable you to switch between the devices back and forth while using the same phone number. All cellular settings are managed on the main iPhone, and location sharing is based on whichever iPhone is actively using the phone number. This sounds amazing for those of us who use multiple iPhones. It?s not a common use case but it?s not that unusual. Developers come to mind, as do, ahem , new-phone reviewers. I presume there are a lot of people in Cupertino who use multiple iPhones, too. The only downside is that it requires carrier support. Hopefully they?ll all adopt it as quickly as they did for, say, cellular Apple Watches. ?

5. Elizabeth Warren?s Incoherent Outrage Regarding Apple?s Tariff Refund

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-27T20:46:08Z

Link: <https://www.warren.senate.gov/newsroom/press-releases/warren-pushes-giant-corporations-to-give-billions-in-tariff-refunds-back-to-consumers/>

Speaking of tariff refunds , here?s an official statement from Senator Elizabeth Warren from a few weeks ago: U.S. Senator Elizabeth Warren (D-Mass.) wrote to Target, Apple, Amazon, Nike, Motorola, Walmart, and Energizer pushing these companies ? each of which have or are expected to receive massive rebates from the Trump Administration for tariffs paid last year ? to provide refunds to customers. ?I urge you to pass along any refund you may receive to the consumers who paid higher prices for your products while the tariffs were in place,? wrote Senator Warren. On Twitter/X, she posted : NEW: Apple reportedly got \$2.2 BILLION back in tariff refunds. Amazon got \$600 MILLION. What?s their plan to give YOU your money back? Warren published the letters she sent to the CEOs, including Tim Cook : Reports indicate that Apple has applied for a refund of the roughly \$3.3 billion in tariffs you paid in 2025, and as of July 30th, that you have received nearly \$2.2 billion in refunds. This amounts to a multi-billion dollar windfall, which could still grow if more of your refund petitions are granted. You have claimed that you ?plan to reinvest any amount we receive back into U.S. innovation a...

6. Panic Is Refunding Tariff Fees to Playdate Buyers

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-27T20:10:13Z

Link:

<https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/playdate-maker-is-refunding-tariff-fees-to-customers>

Nicole Carpenter and Diego Argüello, reporting for Game Developer: ?There was a specific window of time this year where we charged tariffs to customers,? Panic co-founder Cabel Sasser explained in an e-mail to Game Developer confirming the news. ?We tried absorbing the cost for a while, but that was financially difficult for a small company like ours. We made the tariff a very obvious and clearly labeled line item on checkout for any customer affected.? Panic also set up a website to explain the 19% tariff surcharge. [...] The refund amount a customer will get back depends on how much they purchased. ?It?s just not our money to keep, and it felt really good to give it back,? Sasser said. ?That?s an easy way to know you made the right decision.? He continued: ?Still, it took a lot of work for us to file all the paperwork to get the refund from the government, and it took work to build a little system to process the refund, and sometimes it felt like, wait, why are we seemingly doing more work than even gigantic companies are on this issue? That felt weird. But I guess it makes sense in a way, because our small size means we?re far more directly affected by something like a tariff.?

7. The perils of binding to value types in XAML

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 02 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260902-00/?p=112668>

Loss of identity. The post The perils of binding to value types in XAML appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. How to protect yourself from workslop

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Wed, 02 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/how-to-protect-yourself-from-workslop/>

?Workslop? is when your colleagues or bosses communicate with you by pasting big chunks of AI-generated text. The core problem with workslop is that the effort involved is asymmetrical , like a denial-of-service attack : it takes almost no effort to produce text with AI, but it still costs effort to read 1 . Here are some ways to protect yourself. If you have enough authority or social capital, you can and should simply tell them ?hey, don?t do that? (for instance, if you?re a senior engineer and an intern starts doing this to you). This is the easiest way to handle workslop. But you probably aren?t in a position to have that conversation with all of your colleagues, and you certainly can?t have it with everyone in your management chain. One step above just telling a colleague to stop is to drive them around like a coding agent . I wrote about this in AI makes weak engineers less harmful : if a colleague is simply pasting your messages into Claude Code and sending you the outputs, you can treat them like a high-latency Slack interface to Claude Code. It won?t be as good as a normal coding agent, but it?ll often be better than nothing. Another strategy is to use AI to fight AI . Th...

9. Static Allocation, Constant Work

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-09-02T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/09/02/static-allocation-constant-work.html>

In reply to this email:

10. Second Quest

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-09-03T03:24:54Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17438215/mapquest-unexpected-revival>

In a normal culture, a company as gray-haired as MapQuest would not be having a straight-on cultural revival in 2026. But our culture is not normal.

11. Pluralistic: Unpermissioned research (02 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 02 Sep 2026 10:19:10 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/02/scrape-scope-scrap/>

Today's links Unpermissioned research: Fighting Trump means preserving the internet, which means scraping. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Leaked advanced PalmOS device specs; Stalwart workers; "I, Rowboat"; SMS uprising; Facebook v switching costs; Capitalism of fools. Upcoming appearances: D?browa G?nicza, Warsaw, Brighton, London, Budapest, South Bend, Hudson, Victoria, Vancouver. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Unpermissioned research (permalink) After half a century of neoliberalism, we are all drenched in capitalism's established religion, the worship of property rights. We are so marinated in property worship that even capitalism's critics frame their critiques in "property talk," to the exclusion of other, more important rights, like human rights, labor rights and privacy rights. To do this is to surrender before the battle even starts. Critics lose when they allow oligarchs and their apologists to choose a battlefield where they have a nearly unbeatable advantage. Take privacy: privacy is a human right, not...

12. VC isn?t VC anymore ? understanding the rise of Cancer Capital

Source: Anil Dash | Published: 2026-09-02T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://anildash.com/2026/09/02/cancer-capital/>

We really, really need to talk about venture capital. Because it?s not ?venture capital?

anymore. There's a huge disconnect between what most people think of VC, where an investor has a big fund and cuts checks to help a founder build a company, and the current reality, where a handful of billionaire extremists use the cover of "VC" to advance an outrageous agenda where they're accountable to no one. I'm gonna explain this from a standpoint that almost never gets articulated: I've personally raised tens of millions of dollars in venture capital funding as CEO of startups, and been directly involved as a board member or advisor in raising hundreds of millions more. I've sat in board rooms, across the table from the people I'm talking about here, or been at the industry events that they frequent. So this isn't sour grapes because these VCs wouldn't cut me a check, or some chip on my shoulder about these investors due to a business deal. This is what I know about these bad actors because I'm part of the community of creators and inventors who build the things that they used to invest in back when they still cared about innovation. Many of the trends in society and politics that peo...